gym but none of them spoke to me, sensing the state of mind I was in. I worked myself hard, trying to get the declaration out of my mind, then headed up to my room for some time alone.

In the evening Professor Ratnakar Shetty, our manager, came to my room for a chat. I had known Professor Shetty since I was a youngster in Mumbai. He apologized for what had happened and said he did not agree with the declaration. However, it was a cricketing decision and he did not ever interfere with cricketing decisions as manager. I assured him that it was over and done with and would not affect my contribution to the team.

It was when I was talking to Professor Shetty that Sanjay Manjrekar, who was in Pakistan as a commentator, turned up in my room. Sanjay said that it had been a brave decision to declare and that it was a good sign for Indian cricket. He carried on in that vein until I asked him if he really knew what he was talking about. I explained to him that he was not aware of what had transpired in the dressing room and had arrived at his judgement without knowing the real facts of the matter. I made it clear that I did not appreciate his opinion, which I thought was a deliberate attempt to be different.

The following morning, Rahul finally came to me and said he had heard that I was upset and wanted to have a chat. I informed him that I was indeed upset and there was no way I would pretend otherwise. I asked him what the thinking was behind declaring at the time that he did. It wasn't as if we were pressing for a win, and one over wouldn't have made much difference. We had agreed to a plan at tea and I was doing exactly as I had been told.

Rahul said that the call was taken with the interests of the team in mind. It was important to demonstrate to the Pakistanis that we meant business and were keen to win. I wasn't convinced. First, I said to him that I was batting for the team as well. Yes, I had scored 194, but the 194 was meant to help the team and it was my individual contribution to the team's cause. So to say that the decision was taken in the best interests of the team wasn't altogether correct.

I reminded him of what had happened in Sydney less than a month earlier, when we had both been batting on the fourth evening and Sourav had sent out two or three messages asking when we should declare and Rahul had carried on batting. The two situations were comparable and, if anything, the Sydney declaration was far more significant and may have